

The partner email sequence — draft

Five emails, one a day, for the person who loves somebody with a habit. **Not the person with the habit.** Written 12 Aug 2026 so that email capture can be switched on across /codependency, /codependency-test, /for-her, /partner-drinks, /betrayal-trauma-recovery and the rest of the partner side — which currently has no follow-up at all.

Not wired in yet. Jacques reads these and changes whatever doesn't sound like him before any of it goes near server/email.js.

Made partner-neutral 15 Aug 2026. The copy rule in KEYWORDS.md (from the Semrush research) says the supporter is not always a wife and the person with the habit is not always a husband. Every email now says **your partner / the person you love** instead of "him" and "her", and names husband, wife, boyfriend, girlfriend once so every reader sees themselves. Do not re-gender it.

The rules this sequence follows

- **No day counting, no relapse talk, no quitting advice.** The reader isn't quitting anything. Every existing sequence is written to the person with the habit and would land wrong here.
- **Never tells them to leave, and never tells them to stay.** That is their call and nobody else's.
- **Never asks them to manage their partner.** No monitoring tips, no "how to help them quit". The whole point is that their recovery is not your job.
- **Jacques's angle is the one nobody else has:** he was the person with the secret for 38 years. He can say what was actually going on behind the behavior, which their friends and their family cannot.
- Story, not statistics. No "research shows", no brain chemistry.
- Habit-agnostic where possible — drink, porn, gambling, food, the phone.

Email 1 — Day 0

Subject: You're not imagining it

Jacques here. I built this thing, so you get an email from me and not a robot.

I'm going to start with the thing nobody said to you: you're not imagining it, and you're not dramatic, and you're not "reading into things."

I know that because I was the one being read. For thirty-eight years I was the person with the secret in the house. And every single time somebody close to me noticed something was off, they were right. Every time. Not once was anybody wrong about me — they just couldn't prove it, and I was very good at making them feel unreasonable for asking.

So if you've been told you're paranoid, or too sensitive, or that you're making something out of nothing — I'd trust what you noticed over what you were told about noticing it.

And none of this depends on who the two of you are. A husband, a wife, a boyfriend, a girlfriend, a partner — the doubt feels the same from every side of it.

That's all for today. Tomorrow I'll tell you the one thing that changed everything for the people around me, and it isn't what you'd expect.

— Jacques

Email 2 — Day 1

Subject: Two jobs, and you only ever had one

There are two jobs in your house.

One is theirs: stopping, and staying stopped, and dealing with whatever the drink or the phone or the betting was covering up. The other is yours: sleeping, eating, seeing your friends, being someone other than the person who manages them.

Almost everybody in your position quietly takes on both. It's not weakness — it's what happens when somebody has to keep the household upright and nobody else is going to. But here's the thing I watched from the other side: **me not getting better was never once caused by somebody not managing me well enough.** Nobody talked me into it and nobody could have. The people who tried the hardest just got the most worn out.

Your healing does not have to wait in a queue behind theirs.

That's not permission to stop caring. It's permission to stop carrying the half that was never yours.

— Jacques

Email 3 — Day 2

Subject: The ten minutes when you want to check their phone

You know the ten minutes. They're in the shower, or asleep, or out, and the phone is right there, and you hate that you want to look and you're going to look anyway.

I'm not going to tell you not to. Checking is not a character flaw — it's what a person does when they've been lied to and their own judgment stopped feeling reliable. That's the real injury, by the way. Not the drinking. The fact that you can't trust your own read on your own life anymore.

Here's what I'd say instead. Whatever you find, you already know. You've known for a while. Checking doesn't give you information — it gives you thirty seconds of certainty and then a worse night.

So: when the ten minutes come, write it down instead. In the app, in a notebook, in your phone's notes. There's a journal in there that nobody else can open, and it's free. Put the 2am sentence somewhere other than around and around your own head.

It won't fix anything tonight. It'll give you back one night.

— Jacques

Email 4 — Day 3

Subject: A promise and a change look identical from the outside

This is the one I owe you an honest answer on, because I made a lot of promises and meant every single one of them.

That's what nobody tells you. They aren't lies at the moment they're said. At 9am I completely intended it. By 6pm I was a different set of priorities with the same face. Which is why "they promised" and "they lied to me" both feel true — they *are* both true, and living inside that contradiction is exhausting.

So here's the only thing I know that separates a promise from a change, and it's not what they say:

A promise is about the future. A change shows up in the boring middle of an ordinary week. Not a grand declaration after a bad night — the Tuesday. Did anything about the Tuesday get different? That's the whole test. It takes weeks to read, it can't be rushed, and it's the only honest measure there is.

You don't have to decide anything based on it. Just stop grading them on the apologies. They were never the evidence.

— Jacques

Email 5 — Day 4

Subject: One thing this week that's yours

Last one, then I'll leave you alone.

I want you to do one thing this week that has nothing to do with them. Not a grand gesture. One hour, one coffee, one walk, one phone call to the friend you've been too tired to ring back.

I'm asking because of something I saw and can't unsee. The people around me disappeared slowly. Not in a dramatic way — they just stopped having answers to "what have you been up to?", because the answer was *them*, for years. By the time I finally stopped, some of them had no idea what they even liked anymore. That was mine too. That was on my account.

Don't let that be yours.

The app's free and there's a section built for your side of it — not monitoring tools, not couples homework. Yours. Use it, don't use it, that's genuinely fine. But do the one hour.

You've been the reliable one for a long time. Somebody should be telling you to put it down for an afternoon, so it may as well be me.

— Jacques

If it ever grows past five

Written but not sequenced, in case there's a Day 5-7 later: what to say to the kids; the version where they stopped and got worse ([link](#) /dry-drunk); and how to tell an AI-Anon room from a therapist and when each is the right call.